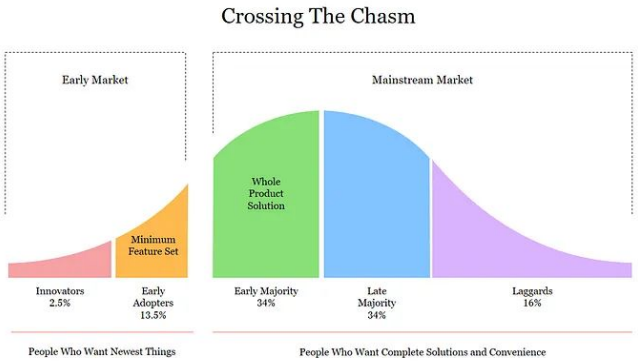
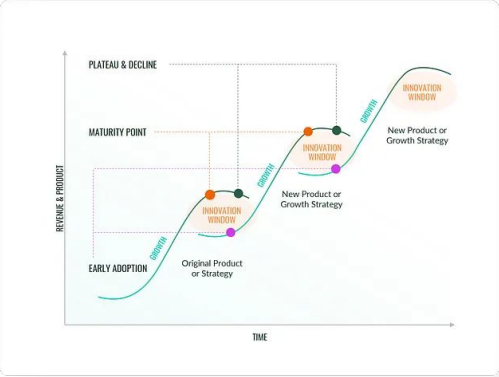
Product Leadership beyond the Horizon: Crossing the Chasm in the S Curve



Sam Ho
June 2024



Multiple related frameworks (S Curve)

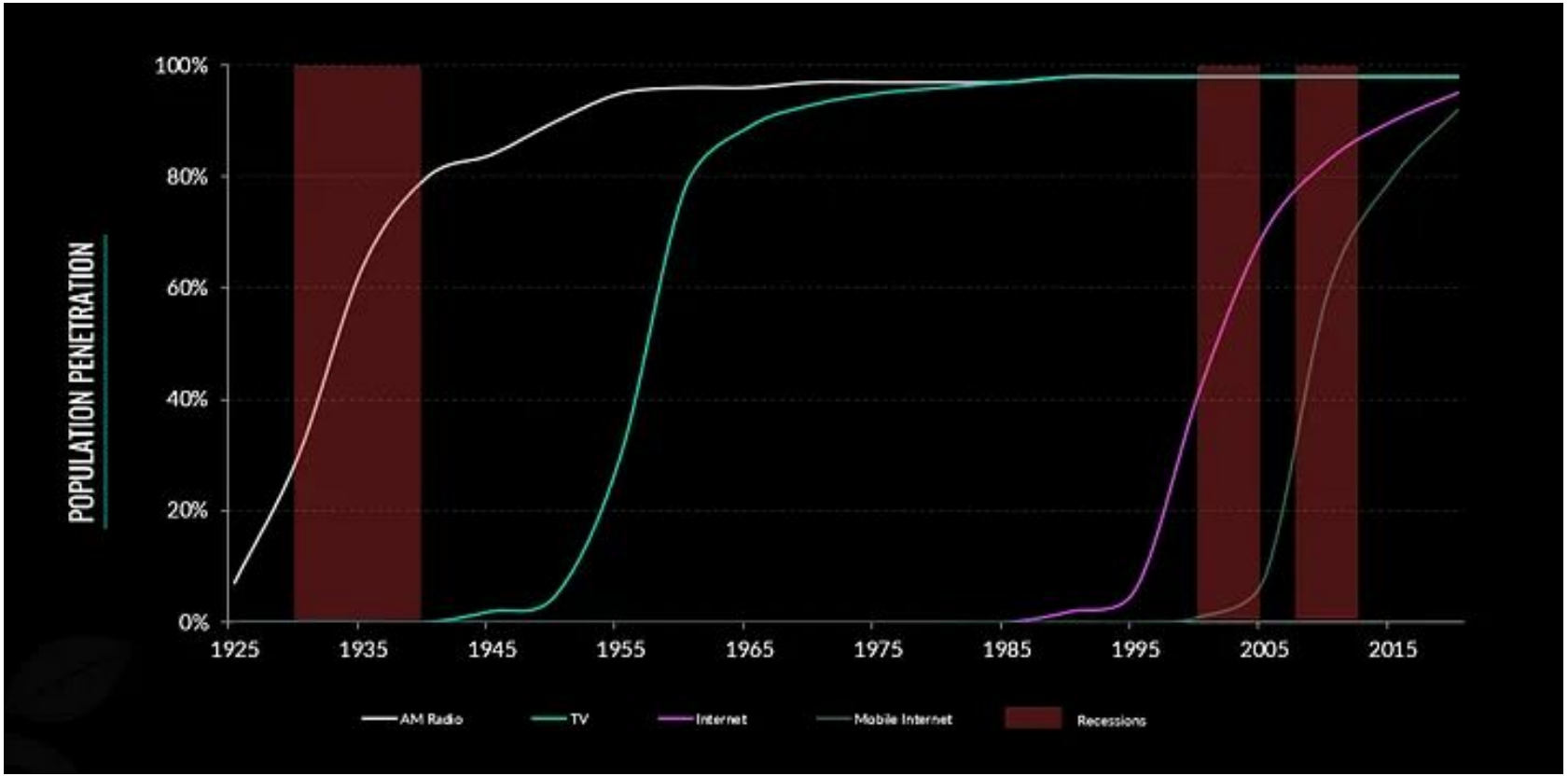
1. S Curve and Technology Adoption
2. Crossing the Chasm (Geoffrey Moore)
3. Explore - Expand - Contract (Kent Beck)
4. 3 Horizons Model

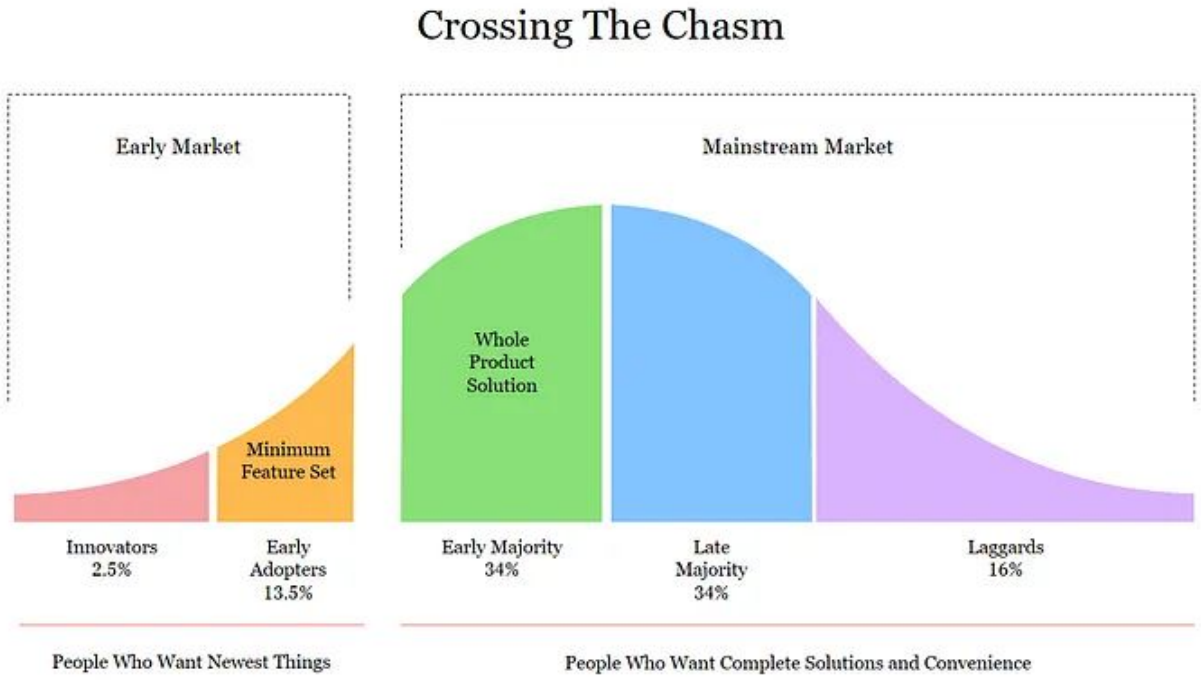
PM Mental Model - 3 types of PMs

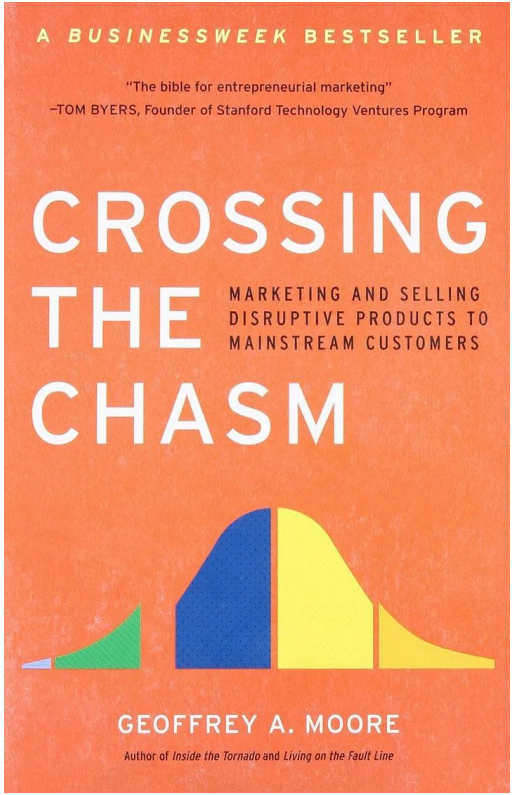
How to apply it in your daily product life?

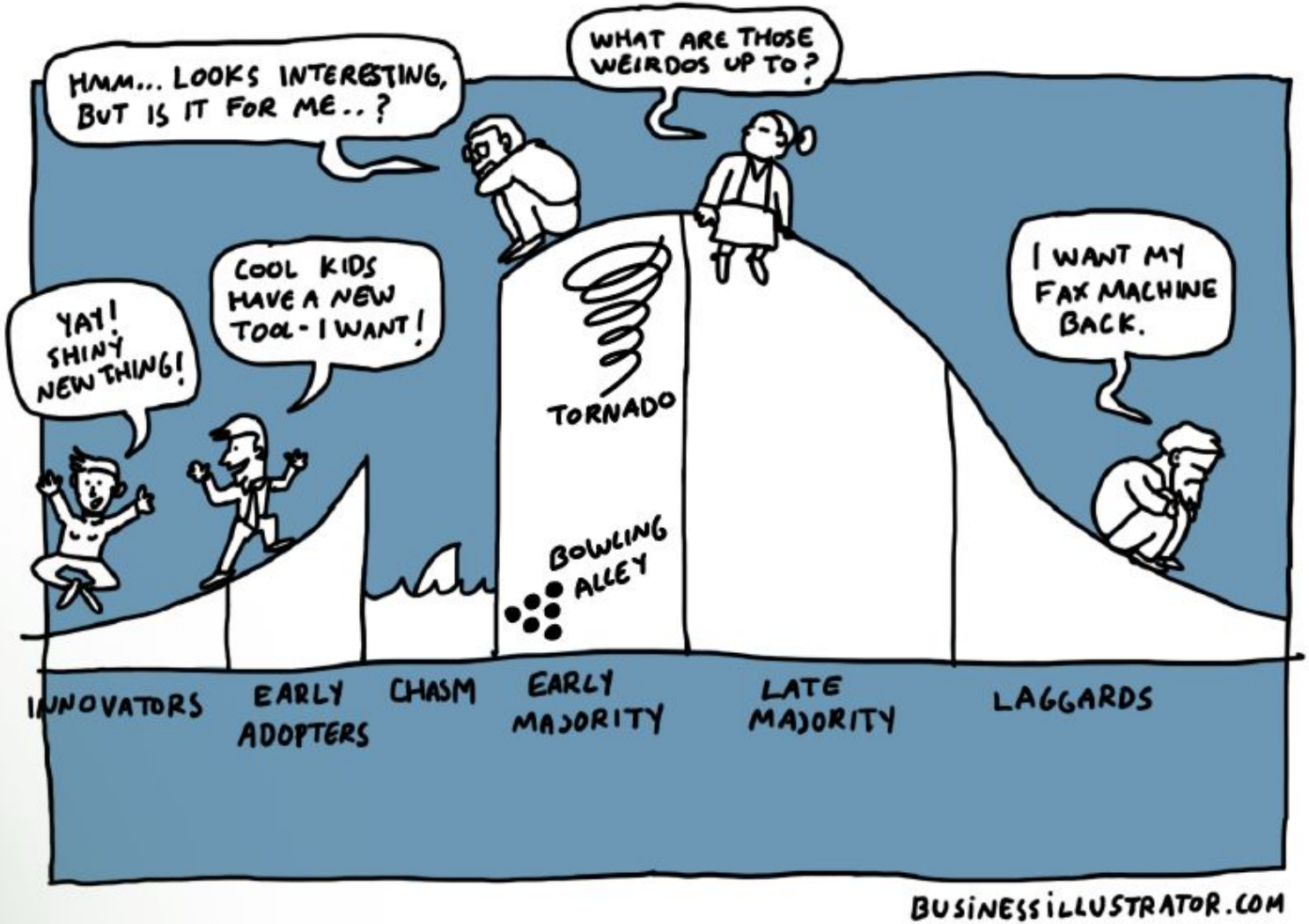
Applied not just at product strategy level, but at your individual product as well in some sense (adoption curve)

S Curve Background




Crossing The Chasm
Early Market
Mainstream Market
Whole Product Solution
Minimum Feature Set
Innovators 2.5%
Early Adopters 13.5%
Early Majority 34%
Late Majority 34%
Laggards 16%
People Who Want Newest Things
People Who Want Complete Solutions and Convenience

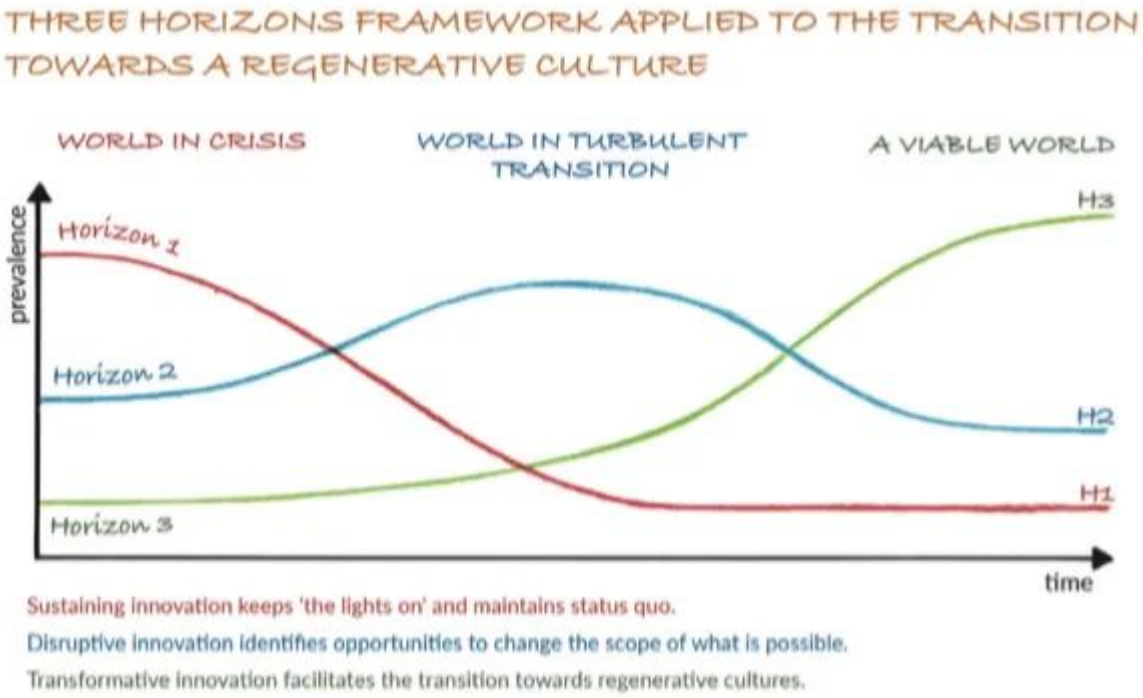

A BUSINESSWEEK BESTSELLER
"The bible for entrepreneurial marketing"
–TOM BYERS, Founder of Stanford Technology Ventures Program
CROSSING THE CHASM
MARKETING AND SELLING DISRUPTIVE PRODUCTS TO MAINSTREAM CUSTOMERS
GEOFFREY A. MOORE
Author of Inside the Tornado and Living on the Fault Line

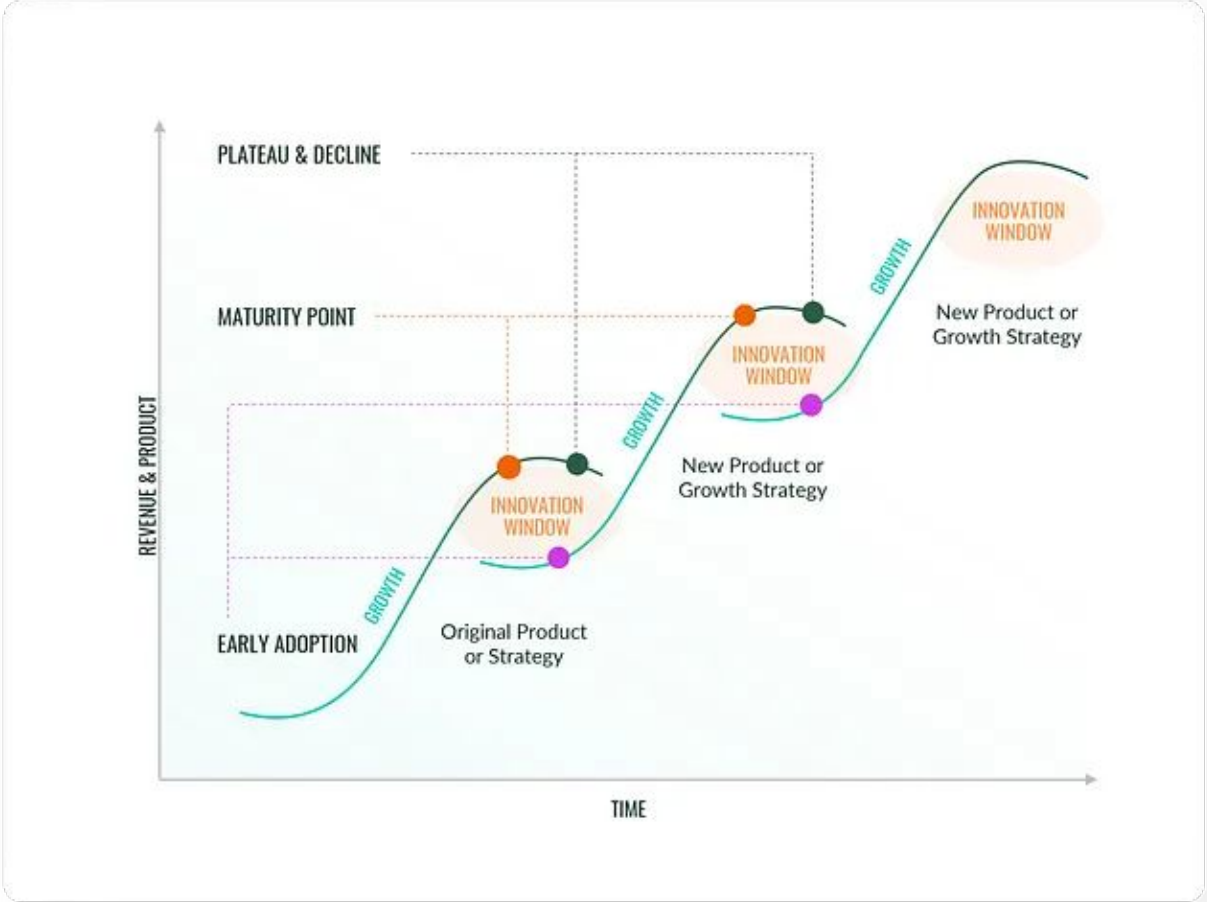

HMM... LOOKS INTERESTING, BUT IS IT FOR ME..?
WHAT ARE THOSE WEIRDOS UP TO?
YAY! SHINY NEW THING!
COOL KIDS HAVE A NEW TOOL - I WANT!
TORNADO
BOWLING ALLEY
I WANT MY FAX MACHINE BACK.
INNOVATORS
EARLY ADOPTERS
CHASM
EARLY MAJORITY
LATE MAJORITY
LAGGARDS
BUSINESSILLUSTRATOR.COM

Kent Beck - Explore - Expand - Contract

EXPLOREEXPANDEXTRACT

3 Horizons


THREE HORIZONS FRAMEWORK APPLIED TO THE TRANSITION TOWARDS A REGENERATIVE CULTURE
WORLD IN CRISIS
WORLD IN TURBULENT TRANSITION
A VIABLE WORLD
prevalence
Horizon 1
Horizon 2
Horizon 3
H3
H2
H1
time
Sustaining innovation keeps 'the lights on' and maintains status quo.
Disruptive innovation identifies opportunities to change the scope of what is possible.
Transformative innovation facilitates the transition towards regenerative cultures.



October 3

Source: McKinsey

Published: December 2009

The Three Horizons framework

High-level Amazon examples

Amazon Web Services

Marketplace

Retail (.com)

Horizon 1 ideas provide continuous innovation to a company's existing business model and core capabilities in the short-term.
(e.g. the Amazon App, Returns at Kohl's)

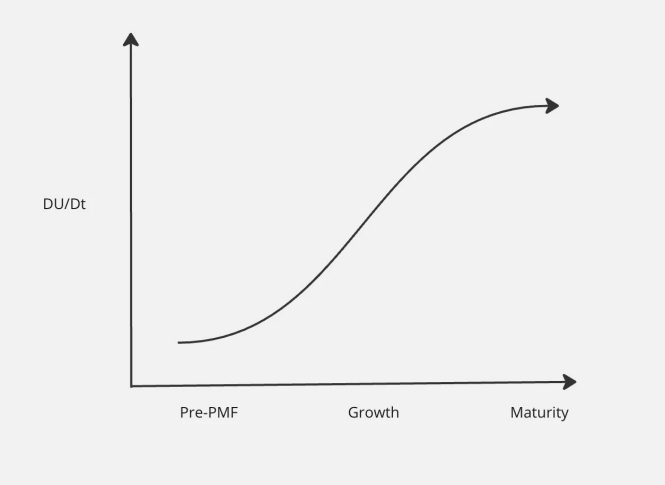
Horizon 2 ideas extend a company's existing business model and core capabilities to new customers, markets, or targets.
(e.g. Amazon Advertising, Fulfillment by Amazon)

Horizon 3 is the creation of new capabilities and new business to take advantage of or respond to disruptive opportunities or to counter disruption.
(e.g. Project Kuiper, Deliveroo investment)

To remain competitive in the long run, a company must allocate its research and development dollars and resources across all 3 Horizons.

Master Mental Model for PM Interviews

1. **PM Type** - Mapped to different stages (requires different skill sets)
2. **PM Skills (Interviews)** - opportunity sizing/guesstimates, market entry, product sense, technical, go-to-market strategy, growth, behavioral, and leadership
3. **Interview -** Tailoring your answers depending on role and stage



Reflective Product Development

	Plan		Build					Launch
			Discover		Deliver			
MAJOR STEPS	Identify Initiatives Foundation Research Stakeholder		Project Kick-off Feasibility Assessment Information Gathering Concepting		Design - Assess		Design - Assess - Repeat	Monitor and Assess Stakeholder
DELIVERABLES	Team Strategy Product Roadmap Initiative One-pagers OKRs Epic Estimates	PLANNING REVIEW	Project Brief Milestone Estimates Early Design Concepts	EARLY STAGE REVIEW	Product Requirements High Fidelity Designs Prototypes JIRA Stories	MID STAGE REVIEW	Code Test Plan	RELEASE REVIEW GTM Plan Release Notes
EVALUATION	Prioritization Impact Sizing Strategic Reviews Roadmap Reviews		Concept Testing Competitive Analysis/Testing User Interviews		Design Reviews Usability Testing (Prototype)		Code Reviews, Q/A Usability Testing (Stage/Live) A/B Testing	Product Adoption KPIs User Feedback, NPS